Genealogy Research Log Plugin

Getting started: install once, then turn any ancestor into a sourced research log

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Genealogy class handout

1. What you need

- A **paid Claude plan** (Pro or Max). Plugins and Claude in Chrome are paid features; see claude.com/pricing.
- The **Claude desktop app** for Mac or Windows, from claude.ai/download.
- **Google Chrome** on the same computer.
- A free **FamilySearch** account, plus any subscriptions you already have (Ancestry, Findmypast, MyHeritage and others).
- Optional: **LibreOffice** (free) to make PDFs on your own computer.

2. Install the plugin

1. Open the Claude desktop app and sign in.
2. In the left sidebar, click **Customize**, then the **Plugins** tab.
3. Click **Add** → **Add marketplace** → **Add from a repository**.
4. Type `dgheaps9/genealogy-research-log` and confirm.
5. Open the new marketplace and install **genealogy-research-log**.



When installed, it appears under **From marketplaces you added**. Free under the MIT License.

3. Run the setup guide (one time, about 30–45 minutes)

OPEN A NEW CHAT AND TYPE

> *Set up genealogy research.*

Claude walks you through each step, one at a time, and checks that it worked:

1. Install **Claude in Chrome** and sign in with your Claude account.
2. Pick your genealogy sites from Claude's list (up to 20). Sign in to each in Chrome and click **Always allow actions on this site** when asked. **You type your own passwords**; Claude never sees them.
3. Choose a **Genealogy folder** on your computer. Claude adds the subfolders and the research-log toolkit.
4. Create a **Claude Project** (for example "Family Search") and paste in the instructions Claude fills out for you.
5. Run a first test on an ancestor you know well.

4. Research an ancestor

1. Open Chrome and check you are still signed in to your sites, and that Claude is allowed on each.
2. Open a chat **inside your genealogy Project** and type the name, PID and birth facts:

> *Research [full name] (PID [FamilySearch ID]), born [birth date] in [birth place]. Read the attached sources first, then search for new ones. Create the research log.*

3. Leave Chrome alone while Claude reads the attached sources and searches the sites. You can watch.
4. Read the log, then make the Tree Actions yourself in FamilySearch.

Useful follow-ups: "What conflicts did you find?" · "Create a log for his wife too." · "Update the log for Fanny Busby."

5. What you get

A Word file and a PDF in your Genealogy folder, a copy in your Project, and an updated Research Tracker spreadsheet. Seven sections:

1. Identification
2. Vital Events, each rated **Proven** **Probable** **Possible**
3. Spouse(s)
4. Child(ren)
5. Sources, with full citations, a link for every source, and whether it is attached in FamilySearch
6. Research Notes, including every search performed
7. Tree Actions Suggested: step-by-step fixes, with the link you need at each step

Older versions are kept automatically in a Superseded folder.

Good to know

- **Claude never edits FamilySearch.** It suggests; you decide and make each change.
- **Open the original image** before changing your tree.
- **Protect the living:** their logs are marked "LIVING – do not upload to Memories".
- **Site terms are yours to follow.** Claude uses your own logins, one person at a time.
- **Long sessions use more of your plan's allowance.** Heavy researchers may prefer Max.
- **Stuck?** Send Claude a screenshot of what you see.